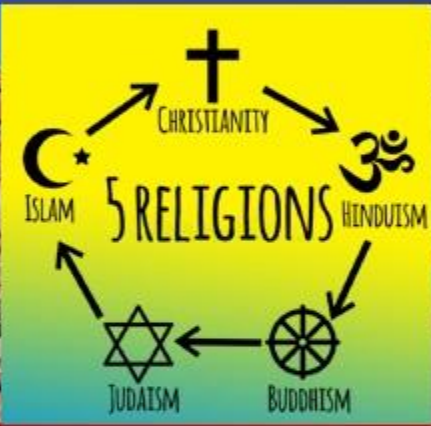


ART & CULTURE



INDIAN DANCE

MODULE - 2

**CLASSICAL DANCE
FORMS**

INDIAN CLASSICAL DANCE FORMS

3

KATHAKALI

- 1 Kathakali is considered to be of comparatively recent origin.

*Koodiyattam*

- 2 However, it is an art which has evolved from many social and religious theatrical forms which existed in the southern region in ancient times.
- 3 *Chakiarkoothu, Koodiyattam, Krishnattam and Ramanattam* are few of the ritual performing arts of Kerala which have had a direct influence on Kathakali in its form and technique.
- 4 Legend has it that the refusal of the Zamorin of Calicut to send his Krishnattam troupe to Travancore, so enraged the Raja of Kottarakkara, that he was inspired to compose the Ramanattam.

INDIAN DANCE FORMS

INDIAN CLASSICAL DANCE FORMS

3

KATHAKALI



Chakiarkoothu



Krishnattam

INDIAN DANCE FORMS

INDIAN CLASSICAL DANCE FORMS

3

KATHAKALI



Vallathol Narayana Menon

- 5 For body movements and choreographical patterns, Kathakali is also indebted to the early martial arts of Kerala.
- 6 These folk drama traditions later became the source of Kathkali, which derived its name from the words “Katha” meaning story and “Kali” meaning dance.
- 7 However, with the breakdown of the feudal set up, Kathkali started to decline as an art form.
- 8 It was revived in the 1930s by the famous Malayali poet Vallathol Narayana Menon under the patronage of Mukunda Raja.

INDIAN DANCE FORMS

INDIAN CLASSICAL DANCE FORMS

3

KATHAKALI

SOME FEATURES OF KATHAKALI DANCE

1 Most Kathakali recitals are a grand representation of the eternal conflict between good and evil. It draws its theme from the stories narrated in the epics and puranas.



Story of good vs evil

2 Kathakali is remarkable in the representation of the rasa through movements of eye and eyebrows. This dance form calls for strenuous training.



Movements of eye

INDIAN DANCE FORMS

INDIAN CLASSICAL DANCE FORMS

3 KATHAKALI

SOME FEATURES OF KATHAKALI DANCE



Facial makeup- an important aspect

3 There is minimal use of props in the Kathakali recital. However, **elaborate facial make up along with a head gear** is used for different characters.

4 Different colors have their own significance:

- **Green** indicates nobility, divinity and virtue.
- **Red** patches beside the nose indicate turmoil.
- **Black** color is used to indicate evil and wickedness.
- **White** colour indicates spirituality.

INDIAN DANCE FORMS

INDIAN CLASSICAL DANCE FORMS

3

KATHAKALI

SOME FEATURES OF KATHAKALI DANCE

- 5 Kathakali is generally performed in open air theatres or temple premises covered with coarse mats.



Kalivilakku

- 6 A brass lamp is used for lighting and this is called a **Kalivilakku** (kali meaning dance; vilakku meaning lamp).
- 7 The performance happens in the front of a huge Kalivilakku with its thick wick sunk in coconut oil, burning with a yellow light.
- 8 Traditionally, before the advent of electricity, this special large lamp provided light during the night. As the play progressed, the actor-dancers would gather around this lamp so that audience could see what they are expressing.

INDIAN DANCE FORMS

INDIAN CLASSICAL DANCE FORMS

3 KATHAKALI

SOME FEATURES OF KATHAKALI DANCE



*Top: Maddalam
Right: Chhenda*

- 9 Kathakali dance is chiefly interpretative. The characters in a Kathakali performance are broadly divided into **satvika**, **rajasika** and **tamasika** types.
- 10 Music is central to a Kathakali performance. Three major drums found are **Maddalam** (barrel shaped), **Chhenda** (cylindrical drum played with curved sticks) and **Idakka** (hourglass shaped drum with muted and melodious notes played when female characters perform).

INDIAN DANCE FORMS

INDIAN CLASSICAL DANCE FORMS

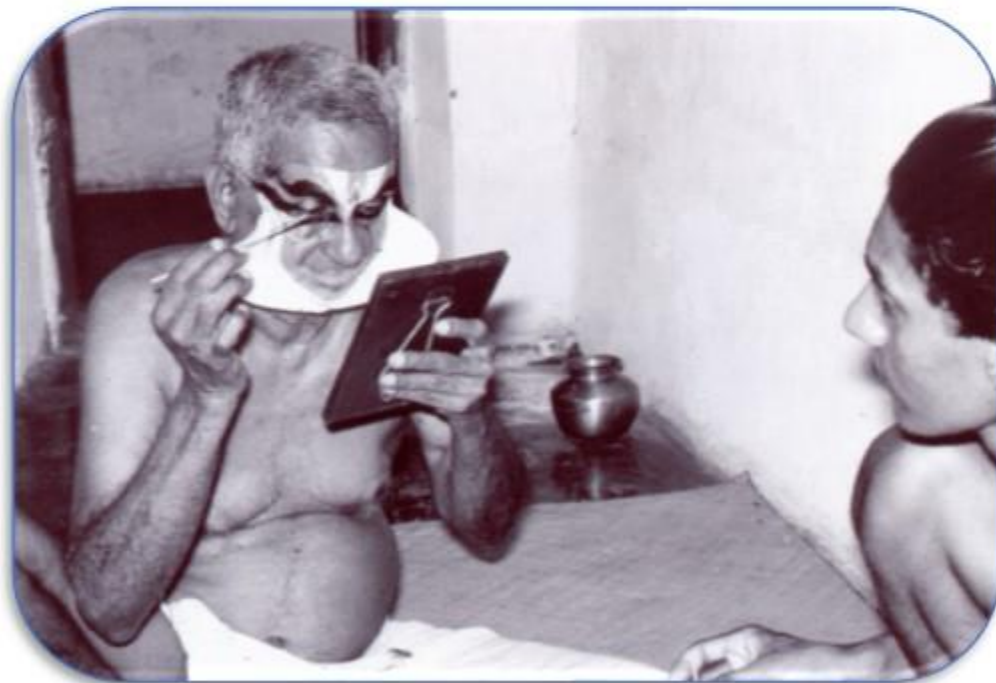
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KATHAKALI

SOME FEATURES OF KATHAKALI DANCE

FAMOUS PROPONENTS

Guru Kunchu Kurup, Gopi Nath, Rita Ganguly etc.



Guru Kunchu Kurup



Rita Ganguly

INDIAN DANCE FORMS

INDIAN CLASSICAL DANCE FORMS

4

MOHINIATTAM



1 Mohiniattam or the Dance of an Enchantress (“Mohini” meaning beautiful woman and “Attam” means dance), is essentially a solo dance that gained prominence under the rulers of Travancore in the present State of Kerala.

2 After it had fallen to obscurity, the famous Malayali poet V.N.Menon revived it along with Kalyani Amma.

INDIAN DANCE FORMS

INDIAN CLASSICAL DANCE FORMS

4 MOHINIATTAM

SOME FEATURES OF MOHINIATTAM DANCE



Mythical Mohini- a famous female avatar of Hindu God Vishnu

- 1 Mohiniattam combines the grace and elegance of Bharatnatyam with the vigour of Kathakali.
- 2 Mohiniattam generally narrates the story of the feminine dance of Vishnu.
- 3 The **Lasya** aspect of dance is dominant in a Mohiniattam recital. Hence, it is mainly performed by female dancers.

INDIAN DANCE FORMS

INDIAN CLASSICAL DANCE FORMS

4 MOHINIATTAM

SOME FEATURES OF MOHINIATTAM DANCE



Sunanda Nair

- 4 Costume is of special importance in Mohiniattam, with white and off-white being the principal colours.

FAMOUS PROPONENTS

Sunanda Nair, Madhuri amma, Jayaprabha Menon etc.

INDIAN DANCE FORMS

INDIAN CLASSICAL DANCE FORMS

5

ODISSI

- 1 The caves of Khandagiri – Udaigiri provide some of the earliest examples of Odissi dance.



Udaigiri – Khandagiri caves

- 2 The Natya Shastra mentions many regional varieties, such as the south-eastern style known as the Odhra Magadha which can be identified as the earliest precursor of present day Odissi.
- 3 It was primarily practised by the 'maharis' and patronised by the King Kharavela.
- 4 The maharis (similar to devadasis of south India) who were originally temple dancers came to be employed in royal courts which resulted in the degeneration of the art form.

INDIAN DANCE FORMS

INDIAN CLASSICAL DANCE FORMS

5

ODISSI



Indrani Rehman

5

It received a tremendous fillip in the 12th century when Poet Jayadeva who was a great devotee of Lord Jagannatha at the Puri temple, wrote his immortal love song Geetagovinda.

6

Young boys were recruited and dressed as females to continue the art form. They came to be known as 'Gotipuas'.

7

Many of today's gurus of this style belong to the gotipua tradition.

8

In the mid-twentieth century, Odissi gained international acclaim due to the efforts of Charles Fabri and Indrani Rehman.

INDIAN DANCE FORMS

INDIAN CLASSICAL DANCE FORMS

5

ODISSI

SOME FEATURES OF ODISSI DANCE



Tribhanga posture

1 It is similar to Bharatnatyam in the use of Mudras and postures to express emotions.

2 The tribhanga posture, i.e. the three-bended form of the body is innate to Odissi dance form.

3 Odissi dance form is unique in its representation of gracefulness, sensuality and beauty. The dancers create intricate geometrical shapes and patterns with her body. Hence, it is known as 'mobile sculpture'.

INDIAN DANCE FORMS

INDIAN CLASSICAL DANCE FORMS

5

ODISSI

SOME FEATURES OF ODISSI DANCE



A male Odissi dancer

4 Odissi closely follows the **tenets** laid down by the **Natya Shastra**.

5 Facial expressions, hand gestures and body movements are used to suggest a certain feeling, an emotion or one of the nine rasas.

6 The techniques of movement are built around the two basic postures of the **Chowk** and the **Tribhanga**.

INDIAN DANCE FORMS

INDIAN CLASSICAL DANCE FORMS

5

ODISSI

SOME FEATURES OF ODISSI DANCE

- 7
- The **chowk** is a position imitating a square - a very masculine stance with the weight of the body equally balanced.
 - The **tribhanga** is a very feminine stance where the body is deflected at the neck, torso and the knees.



Chowk posture



Tribhanga posture

INDIAN DANCE FORMS

INDIAN CLASSICAL DANCE FORMS

5

ODISSI

SOME FEATURES OF ODISSI DANCE



Credits: Wikipedia

8

The elements of Odissi dance forms include:

- ❖ **Mangalacharan** or the beginning
- ❖ **Batu** comprising of the dance bringing out the duality of the masculine and the feminine through the basic stance of the chowk and tribhanga.
- ❖ **Pallavi** which includes the facial expressions and the representation of the song.
- ❖ **Tharijham** again consist of pure dance before the conclusion

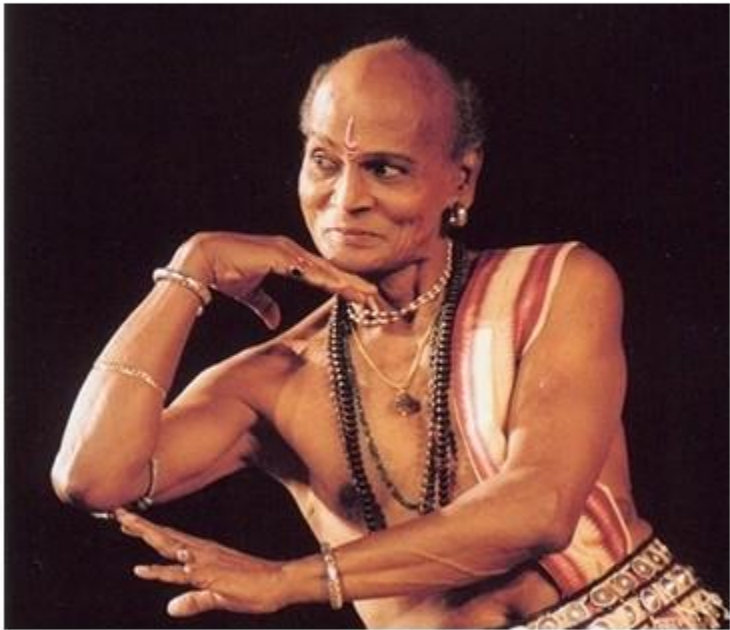
INDIAN DANCE FORMS

INDIAN CLASSICAL DANCE FORMS

5

ODISSI

SOME FEATURES OF ODISSI DANCE



Guru Kelu Charan Mohapatra

8

The elements of Odissi dance forms include: (continued)

- ❖ The concluding item is of two types.
 1. **Moksha** includes joyous movements signifying liberation.
 2. **Trikahnda manjura** is another way of concluding, in which the performer takes leave from the gods, the audience and the stage.

INDIAN DANCE FORMS

INDIAN CLASSICAL DANCE FORMS

5

ODISSI

SOME FEATURES OF ODISSI DANCE



Sharon Lowen, an envoy of Indian culture

9

An Odissi orchestra essentially consists of a **pakhawaj player** (usually the Guru himself), a singer, a flutist, a sitar or violin player and a manjira player.

FAMOUS PROPONENTS

Guru Pankaj Charan Das, Guru Kelu Charan Mohapatra, Sonal Mansingh, Sharon Lowen (USA), Myrla Barvie (Argentina).

INDIAN DANCE FORMS

INDIAN CLASSICAL DANCE FORMS

6

MANIPURI



- 1 Manipuri dance form finds its mythological origins to the celestial dance of Shiva and Parvati in the valleys of Manipur along with the 'Gandharvas'.
- 2 The dance gained prominence with the advent of Vaishnavism.
- 3 In the modern times, Rabindra Nath Tagore brought back the dance form into limelight when he introduced it in Shantiniketan.

INDIAN DANCE FORMS

INDIAN CLASSICAL DANCE FORMS

6

MANIPURI



Lai Haraoba

- 4 Lai Haraoba is one of the main festivals still performed in Manipur which has its roots in the pre-Vaishnavite period.
- 5 This dance is also performed in the Lai Haraoba festival.
- 6 Literally meaning - the merrymaking of the gods, it is performed as a ceremonial offering of song and dance.
- 7 The principal performers are the maibas and maibis (priests and priestesses) who re-enact the theme of the creation of the world.

INDIAN DANCE FORMS

INDIAN CLASSICAL DANCE FORMS

6

MANIPURI

- 8 With the arrival of Vaishnavism in the 15th century A.D., new compositions based on episodes from the life of Radha and Krishna were gradually introduced.



- 9 It was in the reign of King Bhagyachandra that the popular Rasleela dances of Manipur originated.

- 10 It is said, that this 18th century philosopher king conceived this complete dance form along with its unique costume and music in a dream.

- 11 The themes often depict the pangs of separation of the gopis and Radha from Krishna.

INDIAN DANCE FORMS

INDIAN CLASSICAL DANCE FORMS

6

MANIPURI

SOME FEATURES OF MANIPURI DANCE



Ras Leela in Manipuri dance

- 1 Manipuri dance is unique in its emphasis on devotion and not sensuality.
- 2 While the dance incorporates both Tandava and Lasya, emphasis is laid on the latter.
- 3 There is limited use of mudras in the Manipuri dance. The focus is mainly on slow and gracious movements of hand and knee positions.
- 4 Ras Leela is a recurring theme of the Manipuri dance recital.

INDIAN DANCE FORMS

INDIAN CLASSICAL DANCE FORMS

6

MANIPURI

SOME FEATURES OF MANIPURI DANCE



Pung



Kartal choloms

5 The male dancers play the Pung and Kartal choloms while dancing.

6 The Pung and Kartal choloms are performed at all social and religious festivals.

7 Compositions of Jayadeva and Chandidas are used extensively.

FAMOUS PROPONENTS

Jhaveri sisters – Nayana, Suverna, Ranjana and Darshana, Guru Bipin Singha.

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